Your place branding writing project

MK009A | Content Management I |

Deadline: 2 November 2026 • Submit through Blackboard

Choose a place you are curious about and help different audiences get to know it. You will explore the place, speak with someone connected to it, and use what you learn to write a feature and other short texts. Think about what makes the place meaningful to people and how you can communicate that honestly (Kavaratzis, 2004).

What you will submit

- A short communication plan explaining your idea, audiences and writing choices, with relevant concepts from the course readings.
- At least four texts for different target groups, including one feature story based on an interview. The feature counts as one of the four texts.
- A reference list for the sources you use.

This is an individual written assignment. There will be no seminar or oral presentation.

1 Choose your place and story

Keep the project manageable. You could focus on a neighbourhood, cultural venue, market, campus space or local initiative that you can visit. Choose one interesting angle rather than trying to describe everything.

For example: How does a local cultural venue help international students get to know Örebro? Your research may reveal both welcoming experiences and things that could be improved.

2 Get to know the place

Look at its website, social media and any useful independent sources. Visit if possible and make notes about what happens there. Speak with someone who can help you understand the place: an organiser, resident, visitor or participant. Arrange at least one interview for your feature.

You might ask: What makes this place special to you? What should a newcomer know? Can you describe a memorable experience here? What could be better?

Explain that the interview is for your course project, ask permission before recording, and keep accurate notes. Save source details so you can check facts and quotations later.

3 Decide who you are writing for

Choose a target group for each text and think about what those readers need. New students, local residents, journalists and community organisations may want different information. Let your research guide these choices.

Turn your research into writing

4 Write your feature

Build the feature around a person, experience or question that helps readers understand the place. A simple structure is:

- Headline and lead: give the story a clear title and an engaging opening based on your reporting.
- Nut graph: explain what the story is about and why it matters to your readers.
- Body: develop the story using interview quotations, observations and useful background. Include different perspectives where relevant.
- Ending: return to a meaningful detail or leave readers with a clear point to consider.

Use real details and accurately recorded quotations. Your feature should help readers understand the place through someone's experience, while recognising that other people may experience it differently.

5 Create the other written texts

Use the same research to write at least three further texts for different target groups. Choose formats that suit your project. For example:

- A press release for local journalists, if you have a genuine news angle.
- A practical webpage for residents who have not visited the place before.
- A LinkedIn text for community organisations or potential partners.

These are examples, not compulsory formats. A social media caption or another suitable written format may also work. Adapt the information, tone and opening for each audience; changing the platform alone does not create a different target group. Label each text with its audience, format and intended platform.

6 Explain your choices and submit

In your short communication plan, explain which place and idea you chose, what you learned, who each text is for, and why you selected its format and platform. Use relevant course concepts to support your decisions. Briefly mention any gaps in your research.

Before submitting, check that you have the plan, at least four texts including the interview-based feature, and your references. Read through once more for clear language, accurate facts and quotations. Follow the Blackboard guidance on AI use and any formatting instructions.

Submit your written portfolio in the Blackboard assignment folder by 2 November 2026. Check Blackboard for the submission time. If you need help with your idea or writing, contact Ahmed El Gody at ahmed.elgody@oru.se.

Reading to support your work

Use the assigned sections of Smith's Becoming a Public Relations Writer, Friedmann's Writing for Visual Media, and the Blackboard readings. Cite the editions you actually use.

Optional: Kavaratzis, M. (2004). From city marketing to city branding: Towards a theoretical framework for developing city brands. Place Branding, 1, 58–73. https://doi.org/10.1057/palgrave.pb.5990005